Oral Cancer Screening

Community Dentistry

URL: `/dental-care/community-dentistry/oral-cancer-screening`

Oral cancer screening is a clinical examination that looks for unusual changes in the mouth, lips and surrounding oral tissues that may require further investigation. It can help identify suspicious areas early, allowing patients to receive appropriate diagnostic evaluation without unnecessary delay.

Screening is particularly important for people who use tobacco, chew betel nut or areca nut, or have other relevant risk factors. However, oral cancer can also occur in people without these risk factors, so unexplained changes inside the mouth should never be ignored.

At Jerush Dentofacial & Cosmetic Laser Centre, oral cancer screening can support awareness, early recognition of suspicious changes and referral for further investigation when needed.

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What Does an Oral Cancer Screening Check?

During the examination, the clinician looks for changes in the oral tissues that may need closer attention.

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White or red patches

Unusual patches on the tongue, cheeks, gums or other areas of the mouth may need further evaluation, especially when they persist or cannot be explained by a clear cause.

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Persistent sores or ulcers

An ulcer that does not heal, bleeds without a clear cause or gradually changes in appearance should be examined by a qualified clinician.

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Changes in the tongue and oral tissues

The clinician checks for unexplained lumps, thickened areas, restricted tongue movement and other changes that may require further assessment.

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The surrounding head and neck area

Depending on the clinical findings, the examination may include checking the neck for unusual lumps or enlarged lymph nodes.

Who Should Consider Oral Cancer Screening?

An oral examination may be especially important for people who:

- Use cigarettes, bidis, smokeless tobacco or other tobacco products.
- Chew areca nut, betel nut, gutka or betel quid.
- Have a history of potentially malignant oral lesions.
- Notice persistent ulcers, unexplained patches or lumps inside the mouth.
- Experience progressive difficulty opening the mouth or swallowing.
- Have a previous history of oral cancer or require ongoing specialist surveillance.

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People without recognised risk factors can also develop oral cancer. Screening and examination should therefore be guided by symptoms, clinical findings and individual risk rather than assuming that only high-risk individuals need attention.

What Happens During the Screening?

An oral cancer screening is generally a visual and physical examination. It does not, by itself, confirm or exclude cancer.

1. Discussing your history: The clinician asks about symptoms, tobacco or areca nut use, previous oral lesions and relevant medical history.

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2. Examining the mouth: The lips, cheeks, gums, tongue, floor of the mouth, palate and other accessible tissues are checked for suspicious changes.

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3. Checking additional areas: The clinician may examine or gently feel parts of the mouth and neck when indicated.

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4. Recommending further investigation: If an abnormal area is identified, you may be referred for specialist evaluation, a biopsy or other appropriate tests.

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5. Planning follow-up: Depending on the findings, the clinician explains whether routine review, closer monitoring or further diagnostic care is needed.

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Screening, Diagnosis and Prevention

These are related but different parts of oral cancer care.

Stage	Purpose
Oral cancer screening	Looks for suspicious changes that need attention
Diagnostic evaluation	Investigates an abnormal finding; a biopsy may be required
Follow-up and prevention	Monitors relevant lesions and addresses risk factors

A normal screening result does not guarantee that cancer is absent or will never develop. If symptoms persist or change after a screening, arrange another clinical review.

Reducing risk is also important. Avoid tobacco and areca nut products, limit alcohol consumption and seek professional advice about any persistent oral changes.

Frequently Asked Questions

1. Is oral cancer screening painful?

A routine visual examination is generally painless. Some areas may be gently touched or examined, which can cause mild discomfort if the tissues are already sore.

2. Can screening confirm whether I have oral cancer?

No. Screening identifies areas that may need further investigation. A biopsy and histopathological examination are often required to establish a diagnosis when cancer is suspected.

3. How often should I have oral cancer screening?

There is no single screening interval suitable for everyone. Your clinician can advise on the need for examination and follow-up based on your symptoms, risk factors and previous findings.

4. Can oral cancer occur without tobacco use?

Yes. Tobacco is an important risk factor, but oral cancer can also occur in people who do not use tobacco. Persistent or unexplained changes should still be evaluated.

5. Does every white or red patch indicate cancer?

No. Many oral patches have non-cancerous causes. However, persistent or unexplained patches should be examined because appearance alone cannot reliably establish the diagnosis.

6. When should I seek an oral examination?

Arrange an appointment for an unexplained mouth lump, persistent red or white patch, or ulcer that has not healed within three weeks. Seek prompt evaluation sooner if symptoms are worsening or accompanied by difficulty swallowing or a neck lump.

7. What happens if the clinician finds a suspicious area?

You may be referred for further examination and a biopsy if indicated. The next step depends on the appearance, location and clinical findings.

Make Oral Health Awareness a Priority

Recognising suspicious oral changes and arranging timely evaluation can help prevent delays in diagnosis. At Jerush Dentofacial & Cosmetic Laser Centre, oral cancer screening supports awareness and helps guide patients towards appropriate further care when needed.

Book an oral examination if you have persistent changes inside your mouth or would like to discuss your oral health risk factors.

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SEO Details

SEO title

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Meta description

Learn about oral cancer screening at Jerush Dentofacial & Cosmetic Laser Centre, including warning signs, clinical examination and when further investigation may be needed.

Primary keyword

Oral cancer screening

Related keywords

Oral cancer examination, mouth cancer screening, oral lesion examination, oral cancer warning signs, suspicious mouth patches, oral health screening

Suggested image alt text

Dentist examining the tongue and oral tissues during an oral cancer screening